

tains the count of the number of objects that is created. The `show()` function displays the code number for each object. Consider the statement `x = ++y;`

This statement is executed whenever the `set()` function is called and the current value of the variable `y` is assigned to the code.

6.6 Friendly Functions

Consider a case where two classes, `engineer` and `chemist` are defined and we want a function `behavior()` to operate on the objects of these classes. C++ allows the common function to be friendly to both the classes. This allows the particular function to have access to the private data of these classes.

For making a function friendly to a class, we must declare the function as a friend of the class as follows;

```
class MN
{
.....
.....
public:
.....
.....
friend void pqr(void)
};
```

Here, the function `pqr` is declared as a friend function. It should be noted that the function declaration should be preceded by the keyword `friend`. The friend function has some important features as follows:

1. It can be invoked like a normal function without taking the help of any object
2. It normally has the objects as arguments.